Mike Chester

Senior Software Engineer
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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with 12+ years designing, building, and operating backend and distributed systems, currently building AWS Cost Categories and Cost Allocation Tags. Previously led backend development of a highly available eSIM provisioning platform and built API management and hybrid cloud products. Comfortable owning work from design through production and mentoring other engineers.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Development Engineer Amazon Web Services · Vancouver, BC — Apr 2026 – Present
Software Development Engineer — Apr 2020 – Apr 2026

- Build AWS Cost Categories and Cost Allocation Tags on the AWS Commerce Platform, which customers use to organize, allocate, and track their AWS spend across teams, projects, and business units.
- Cost Categories map cost and usage with customer-defined rules and split charges, and surface across Cost Explorer, AWS Budgets, and the Cost and Usage Report.

  Java · AWS

Senior Software Developer IDEMIA · Vancouver, BC — Feb 2018 – Mar 2020

- Led backend development of the core eSIM/SIM orchestration platform as project lead and Python developer.
- Built highly available distributed services for asynchronous eSIM/SIM provisioning from the ground up.
- Owned multiple client projects end to end, from requirements and design through delivery.
- Built operational tooling to diagnose and resolve eSIM/SIM provisioning failures.

  Python · Go · Clojure · PostgreSQL · RabbitMQ · Kafka · SaltStack · AWS

Software Engineer CA Technologies · Vancouver, BC — Aug 2016 – Feb 2018

- Full-stack Java developer on the API Management Portal; helped design and build new 12-factor microservices.
- Designed, implemented, and tested real-time API provisioning to remote API gateways.
- Automated SaaS infrastructure management and customer onboarding with Python tooling.
- Led an internal API-first working group, and mentored colleagues on Python and Git best practices.

  Java · Python · Docker · Kubernetes · OpenShift · PostgreSQL · RabbitMQ · TeamCity

Software Developer Siaras · Burnaby, BC — May 2014 – Aug 2016

- Core Python developer on the cloudScape/cloudBurst hybrid cloud product.
- Built custom OpenStack plugins that put multiple cloud technologies behind one common OpenStack API.
- Implemented end-to-end tests integrated into the CI/CD pipeline.

  Python · MongoDB · OpenStack

PROJECTS

home-cluster Open-source homelab Kubernetes platform, 170+ GitHub stars — github.com/mchestr/home-cluster

- Run a 3-node Talos Linux cluster hosting ~80 apps and platform services, reconciled by Flux, with Cilium BGP networking, Rook-Ceph storage, and Envoy Gateway.
- Renovate updates are validated with flux-local and gated by a fail-closed LLM risk review; daily backups go to Cloudflare R2.

  Kubernetes · Talos · Flux · Cilium · Rook-Ceph · Terraform · GitHub Actions

SKILLS

Languages	Java, Python, Go, Rust, Clojure
Cloud & infrastructure	AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, OpenShift, OpenStack, SaltStack
Data & messaging	PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, RabbitMQ

EDUCATION

B.Eng., Computer Engineering University of Victoria · Victoria, BC — 2009 – 2014
NSERC Undergraduate Student Research Award, 2013
Co-author, *Dynamic web cache publishing for IaaS clouds using Shoal*, arXiv:1311.0058, 2013